

Excel Data Analysis & Beginner-Friendly Dashboard

I am going to upload an Excel file. I am a **beginner in Excel** and only know the basic functions.

Your job is to take my Excel file and help me turn it into a **meaningful, useful, and easy-to-understand dashboard**.

1. First, understand my data

Before creating anything:

- Examine all sheets in the Excel file.
- Identify what each sheet contains.
- Identify important columns, rows, dates, categories, numbers, and other useful fields.
- Check for missing values, duplicates, inconsistent formatting, or obvious data-quality problems.
- Explain the dataset to me in **very simple language**.
- Tell me what questions this data can answer.

Do not assume I understand technical Excel or data-analysis terminology. If you use a technical term, explain it simply.

2. Find meaningful insights

Analyze the data and identify the most useful information.

Look for things such as:

- Total performance
- Trends over time
- Best and worst performers
- Top categories/products/customers/regions/etc.
- Growth or decline
- Important changes
- Comparisons
- Percentages and proportions
- Unusual or unexpected results
- Possible problems or areas requiring attention
- Any other insights that would be useful based on the actual data

Do not just give me a basic summary of the columns. **Find the story in the data.**

For every important insight, explain:

1. What happened?
2. How significant is it?
3. Why might it matter?
4. What action or decision could it lead to?

Clearly separate **facts found in the data** from assumptions or possible explanations.

3. Design a dashboard

Based on the actual Excel data, design a professional but **beginner-friendly dashboard**.

The dashboard should preferably contain:

KPI cards

Show the most important numbers at the top, such as:

- Total
- Average
- Growth %
- Number of records
- Best performer
- Other relevant KPIs based on my data

Charts

Choose charts that actually help understand the data.

For example:

- Line chart → trends over time
- Bar chart → comparisons
- Pie/donut chart → simple category proportions when appropriate
- Column chart → rankings
- Other chart types if they are genuinely useful

Do not add charts just to make the dashboard look impressive. Every chart should answer a useful question.

Filters / interactivity

If appropriate, include beginner-friendly filters such as:

- Date
- Category

- Region
- Product
- Customer
- Department
- Other relevant fields

Explain exactly what each filter does.

4. Make the dashboard easy to operate

This is extremely important.

I am a beginner, so after creating the dashboard, give me a section called:

"How to Use This Dashboard — Beginner Guide"

Explain step by step:

- What I am looking at
- What each KPI means
- What each chart tells me
- How to use filters
- How to change the date range
- How to refresh the data
- How to update the dashboard when I add new Excel data
- How to read the charts
- How to find important insights
- What I should check first when opening the dashboard

Use simple language.

For example:

"Click the Region filter at the top. Select North to see only data from the North region."

Avoid instructions like "use a slicer" without explaining what a slicer is.

5. Teach me how the dashboard was built

Because I am learning Excel, explain the important parts used to create the dashboard.

For example:

- Tables
- PivotTables
- PivotCharts

- Formulas
- Conditional formatting
- Filters
- Slicers
- Data validation
- Any other Excel features you use

For each feature, explain:

What it is → Why we used it → How I can use it

Do not overwhelm me with advanced Excel techniques unless they are necessary.

6. Give me a beginner-friendly build guide

After analyzing the file, give me a practical step-by-step guide showing how I could recreate or maintain the dashboard myself in Excel.

Structure it like:

Step 1 — Prepare the data

What I need to do and where to click.

Step 2 — Create the important calculations

Give me the exact formulas if formulas are needed.

Step 3 — Create PivotTables

Tell me exactly which fields should go into:

- Rows
- Columns
- Values
- Filters

Step 4 — Create charts

Tell me which chart to create and which data to select.

Step 5 — Add filters/slicers

Explain exactly how.

Step 6 — Arrange the dashboard

Explain where to place the KPIs, charts, and filters.

Step 7 — Format it

Give me simple formatting recommendations.

Step 8 — Refresh/update it

Explain what I should do when new data is added.

7. Explain the business meaning

Don't stop at Excel.

At the end, give me a section called:

"What This Dashboard Tells Me"

Summarize the most important findings in plain English.

Then give me:

Top 5 Insights

1. 2. 3. 4. 5.

Recommended Actions

Based only on the evidence in the data, suggest practical actions or questions I should investigate.

8. Important rules

- Use the actual uploaded Excel data.
- Do not invent numbers or insights.
- If something cannot be determined from the data, clearly say so.
- Ask me a question only if you genuinely need information that cannot be determined from the file.
- Keep explanations beginner-friendly.
- Avoid unnecessary technical jargon.
- Prefer simple Excel features over complicated solutions.
- Make the dashboard useful rather than overly decorative.
- Explain every important calculation.
- If there are problems with the data, tell me before relying on it.
- If there are multiple possible dashboard designs, recommend the best one and explain why.

Final output

Please organize your response in this order:

1. **What is in my Excel file**
2. **Data quality issues**
3. **What questions this data can answer**
4. **Key insights**
5. **Recommended KPIs**
6. **Recommended dashboard design**
7. **How to build the dashboard in Excel**
8. **How to operate the dashboard — Beginner Guide**
9. **How to update/refresh the dashboard**
10. **What the dashboard tells me**
11. **Top 5 insights**
12. **Recommended actions**
13. **Excel skills I should learn next**

Remember: **I am a beginner. Teach me while doing the analysis.**